

Egla Mekonnen

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Data Science & AI graduate with internship experience in data analytics, audit operations, and AI-focused projects. Skilled in Python, machine learning, data visualization, and exploratory data analysis, with hands-on experience building real-time pipelines and LLM-based applications. Upsilon Pi Epsilon Honor Society member graduating Magna Cum Laude with a Mathematics minor. Seeking an entry-level Data Science, AI, or Data Analytics role.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Programming: Python, R

Libraries/Tools: Pandas, NumPy, Scikit-learn, Gemini/Vertex AI APIs, LangChain

AI/ML: Machine Learning, LLMs, RAG, Vector Databases, AI Governance & Bias Evaluation

Data Analytics & BI: Tableau, Data Cleaning, EDA, Interactive Dashboards, Predictive Analytics

PROJECTS

Real-Time Financial Sentiment Classifier | Python, Gemini API, Hugging Face, Git/GitHub

- Built a real-time financial sentiment analysis pipeline using Python and LLM-based classification models to analyze live financial news data
- Integrated the Yahoo Finance API for automated live news ingestion and preprocessing workflows
- Utilized Hugging Face for model and dataset research, benchmarking classification accuracy, and testing the LLM's capability to interpret financial sarcasm and market slang accurately.

[REEL Vendor Network AI Search Engine](#) | Gemini API, Streamlit, Git/GitHub

- Collaborated on a team to develop a Gemini-powered recommendation system that leverages multi-format user inputs to generate personalized venue matches exclusively within the REEL Vendor Network
- Designed an interactive Streamlit intake interface supporting image uploads and digital sketch inputs, utilizing Gemini's capabilities to process visual and text data seamlessly

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Citizens Bank, Internal Audit – Operations & Data Analytics Co-Op Intern

February – May 2026

- Led the development of an AI playbook project for Internal Audit teams, creating a SharePoint-based prompt library and governance framework to support responsible AI adoption with risk and intensity control
- Designed and rolled out a department-wide GenAI usage survey, executing data collection and analytics on responses to identify operational bottlenecks and develop a strategic roadmap for tool encouragement.
- Performed validation testing on newly developed automation tools, executing technical test scenarios to identify script errors, ensure reliable system performance, and verify output accuracy before deployment

Skills for Rhode Island's Future, Fellowship

November 2024 – September 2025

- Improved an Excel-based tracking system through data cleaning, validation, and workflow optimization to increase reporting accuracy
- Tracked operational KPIs through the creation of automated dashboards and recurring reports, optimizing program visibility and supporting strategic decision-making
- Co-designed and co-hosted an AI Literacy Workshop for small business owners on responsible AI adoption and practical applications

Rhode Island College Career Center, Student Consultant

September– November 2024

- Managed student employment and operational records, ensuring data accuracy, confidentiality, and compliance with institutional policies
- Utilized Excel for data organization and basic analysis, supporting accurate recordkeeping and operational monitoring

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATION

Rhode Island College

May 2026

Bachelor of Science: Data Science & Artificial Intelligence. Minor: Mathematics

Honors: Magna Cum Laude; Upsilon Pi Epsilon (International Honor Society for the Computing and Information Disciplines)

Bunker Hill Community College

May 2024

Associate of Science

AWS Academy Machine Learning Foundations Certificate | Google Data Analytics Certificate